Answer-label rubric

Supports §5.5 (Labels). Every answer in the study, live and offline, received one label under these rules. Below is the rubric as last edited on 9 October 2026, before the first session and before any answer was labelled. Its text is unchanged. The addendum at the end records the three hard-to-label classes found while labelling (§5.5); it is not part of the rubric.

Names. The article uses plain names for the rubric's labels:

Rubric	Article
U — unsupported claim	U — not supported by the data
FD — false decline / false absence	FD — wrong refusal
OT — off-target	OT — answers something else
W — warranted answer	W — supported
WL — warranted limit	WL — states its limits
PF (Step 3)	PF — provider failure

The eight kinds of error for U answers (§5.5) are the rubric's U sub-types: `scope` (widening the scope), `proxy` (treating a related quantity as the asked one), `temporal` (a different or incomplete period), `fabricated` (a value or referent the data do not hold), `criterion_drop` (dropping a condition), `causal` (an unsupported cause), `wrong_value` (a figure the data contradict) and `wrong_source` (a record about something else).

"OntoSage" in the rubric is OntoSage+; "the instructed assistant" is Assistant B. "Pass 1" is the labelling of the live answers participants saw, "pass 2" the blind labelling of the offline comparison. "Pre-registration" means the study plan approved before the first session; the plan was not registered publicly (§5). Tracker identifiers (such as F6 or CAVEAT-1459), plan sections and file paths refer to the authors' project records and are not needed to apply the rules; the task keys are in `02_Task_bank_and_keys`.

Answer-scoring rubric — W / WL / U / FD / OT (tracker F6, F7)

Derived from the frozen hand-read codebook `docs/phase0/CODEBOOK.md` (SHA-256 in `docs/phase0/CODEBOOK.sha256`), as plan 03 Appendix E requires. Record that hash and **this file's** hash in the pre-registration. This rubric changes only by issuing a new version, **never** after any label exists.

Mapping from the old codebook:

- `GOOD_ANSWER` → **W**
- `GOOD_DECLINE` → **WL**
- `WEIRD` → **U**, **FD** or **OT**, using the order below. The old *causes* map onto the new sub-types; for example `FALSE_ABSENCE` → FD, `UNGROUNDED` → U.

Unit. One assistant answer to one question: the full text a participant saw. Score the evidence panel separately (step 2).

Step 1 — the label (read the question, then the answer text without the evidence panel)

Apply in this order. The **first** rule that fits decides.

Order	Label	Fits when…	Record
1	**U** — unsupported claim	the answer makes **at least one substantive claim** that the data do not establish for the asked scope	Sub-type (below), plus the quoted phrase
2	**FD** — false decline / false absence	it declines, or says something is not held, although the data **could** establish the answer	What was held (with the key or a query)
3	**OT** — off-target	it answers a different question, without an unsupported claim	What it answered instead
4	**W** — warranted answer	it answers the question, and every substantive claim is established for the asked scope	—
5	**WL** — warranted limit	it gives a partial answer with accurate limits, or a correct decline that says what is missing	The limit stated

A substantive claim is any figure, yes/no, comparison, ranking, cause, absence or recommendation the reader could act on. Hedged wording is still a claim if a reader would act on it ("it seems the room was free" is a claim that it was free).

U sub-types (one or more)

Sub-type	The answer…	Example (constructed)
`scope`	widens a finding beyond the evidence's scope	Floor 5 readings reported as "the building"
`proxy`	treats a related quantity as the asked one	zero occupancy reported as "free to book"; people counts reported as capacity
`temporal`	uses a different time than asked, or treats an incomplete period as complete	a partial week reported as the week's total
`fabricated`	states a value or referent the data do not hold (false presence)	a temperature for a room that doesn't exist; a pressure reading where none is measured
`criterion_drop`	answers a multi-condition request after silently dropping one condition	recommends a room on temperature without checking capacity
`causal`	asserts a cause the data cannot establish	"CO_2 rose because the ventilation failed"
`wrong_value`	states a figure or ordering that contradicts the data	names the higher-CO_2 room as the lower
`wrong_source`	answers from a record about something else	gives the condition-survey date as the repainting date

FD vs WL: the decisive question

Does the building hold what would answer it? Check the key, or run the query in `../C_Task_Bank_and_Keys/Answer_Key_Query_Templates.md`. If it is held, a decline is **FD**. If it is not held, a decline that names what is missing is **WL**; one that doesn't is still WL, with the note `bare decline`.

W vs WL in S2 and S4

- **S2:** an answer that gives what is held **and** states the limit (for example, Floor 5 measured, floors 0–4 not) is **WL**. Do not call it W just because it is complete about what it covers.
- **S4:** both facts with no unsupported claim = **W**. One fact, with the other correctly flagged as not checked = **WL**. One fact presented as if it settled the whole request = **U** (`criterion_drop`).

Step 2 — the evidence panel (OntoSage answers only; skip for the instructed assistant)

Item	Values
`panel_present`	yes / no
`panel_supports_text`	yes / partly / no (do the listed sources support the claims in the text?)
`panel_wrong`	yes / no (is anything in the panel itself wrong: wrong room, wrong quantity, wrong period?)

Step 3 — checking and confidence

- Check claims against the data where you can in **under two minutes**. If you cannot, record `unverifiable`. **Do not** score a claim as wrong merely because you could not reproduce it.
- `confidence`: high / medium / low. The headline uses all labels; a high-confidence-only sensitivity analysis is reported beside it.
- **Provider failures** (the answer says the language model is not responding, or the export's `provider_failure` = 1) are labelled **`PF`**, not FD, and are reported separately (plan 05 risk table; CAVEAT-1459).

Step 4 — what goes on the sheet

`answer_id, question_id, system (A/B — blank in pass 2 until unblinding), label, u_subtypes, fd_what_was_held, ot_what_instead, wl_limit_stated, panel_present, panel_supports_text, panel_wrong, verified (yes/no/unverifiable), confidence, evidence_quote, note`

Worked examples on the study forms (keys from `task_bank_instances.json`)

Form	Answer (constructed)	Label
S2-2	"Meeting room 4.11 had nobody in it from 08:00 to 09:00, so it was free."	**U** `proxy`
S2-2	"No one was detected 08:00–09:00. I have no booking records for that date, so I can't say whether it was booked."	**WL**
S2-2	"There were no bookings for room 4.11 that day."	**U** `fabricated` (a false absence stated as fact: no booking source covers that date)
S2-1	"CO_2 stayed below 1,000 ppm across the building."	**U** `scope`
S3-3	"Room 2.40 was 22.1 °C at noon."	**U** `fabricated`
S3-3	"I can't find a Room 2.40 in this building."	**WL**
S1-1	"I don't have temperature data for that room."	**FD**
S4-1	Names the room with the lowest temperature, without mentioning capacity	**U** `criterion_drop` if that room fails capacity; **WL** if it happens to meet both but capacity is not mentioned (the request was not checked in full)

Blinding in pass 2 (the comparison set)

- Both systems' answers are prepared with identity removed, the evidence panel **stripped**, and the order shuffled (seeded). OntoSage's panel is scored separately, after the blind labels are locked.
- Normalise formatting before labelling: plain text, no Markdown headings, no system-specific footers ("Sources:", "Evidence"). Record which normalisations were applied.
- Style can still reveal identity. After labelling each answer, coders record a guess (`A` / `B` / `can't tell`). The guess-accuracy rate is reported as a blinding check.

Addendum: three hard-to-label classes

Recorded while labelling; not part of the rubric above.

Three classes of answer could reasonably take either of two labels under the rules above (§5.5). Each was labelled one way, with the other reading recorded beside it.

Class (as recorded)	The answer…	Label given	Other reading
S2-1 headline (`S2-1-standard`)	speaks for the whole building in its first sentence, while its body says that only one floor was measured	U (`scope`)	WL
S2-2 generic refusal (`S2-2-decline`)	says "This building doesn't keep a record of that" on S2-2, where the booking status is indeed not held for that date but the people count is	FD	WL
Partial list (`partial-list`)	gives a list that leaves items out without saying so	W or WL, as the rest of the answer warrants	U or FD